

How plants work

Plants have an amazing system for making and transporting food to all their different parts.

Photosynthesis

The green pigment chlorophyll traps sunlight in the leaves. The Sun's energy is then used to change water and carbon dioxide into sugar.

A waste product of photosynthesis is oxygen, which animals need to survive.

The Sun's energy is trapped in the leaves, and helps make food.

Cross-section through a leaf vein

Food is moved from leaves to roots and growing tips, along a set of tubes called phloem vessels.

Some water evaporates through tiny holes called stomata in the surface of the leaf. This process is called transpiration.

Tiny tubes called xylem vessels carry water up the stem from the roots to the leaves.

Cross-section through a stem

Veins carry water around the leaf.

Roots suck water up from the ground.